



A SPACE ODYSSEY

With private operators entering
the space travel arena, the rich and
famous have found a new way to
experience the universe

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AT THE FAG end of 2021, a momentous event took place in the history of humans' tryst with space travel. Nearly a decade after the US space agency NASA retired its space shuttle programme in 2011, Japanese billionaire Yusaku Maezawa took off from the earth on a Russian Soyuz spacecraft for a 12-day self-funded round trip to the International Space Station (ISS). Accompanying him were veteran Russian cosmonaut Alexander Misurkin, who led the mission, and Maezawa's production assistant and